

Improvement in Food Resource

- Food: Any Organic substance that contains nutrients. i.e; Proteins, Carbohydrate, Fats, Vitamins, Minerals.
- Consumed by living organisms in order to derive energy and support all the vital metabolic activities.
- Food Resource: (Crop)
- A crop is a cultivated population of some type of plants, grown and managed over a larger land area.

1) Food Variety Improvement:

- Focuses on selection of plants with desirable qualities.
 - ↳ Higher Productivity, Increased production per acre.

→ Improved quality = Pulses → Protein
= Oil seeds → oil quality.

→ Increased shelf-life = Fruits and vegetables.

⇒ Biotic and Abiotic resistance:-

- Crop production can go down due to certain biotic factors like - Insects, diseases, nematodes.

→ ~~Abiotic~~ Abiotic factors like - drought, salinity, water lodging, heat, cold, frost.

⇒ Change in maturity duration:-

- ~~Shorter~~ Shorter duration of crops from sowing to harvesting can help farmers to grow multiple rounds of crops.

→ Wider adaptability. Developing various adaptations

pertaining to environment i.e; climate conditions, weather.

⇒ Desirable agronomic trait/character:

- Forage → plant → Tall.
- Food crop → dwarf (short) → because the nutrients utilized for height, will be instead used for production of grains/fruits.

2) Crop Production Management.

- It refers to controlling, organizing and optimizing various practices to ensure maximum yield.
- It is how a farmer manages, nutrients water supply and cropping techniques to help healthy and

abundant growth of crops.

→ Nutrient Management

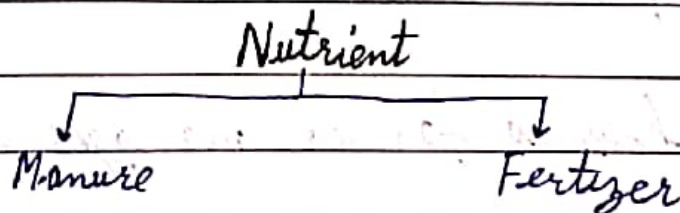
- There are various types of nutrients required by plant.

⇒ Among these are the nutrients required in large quantities, these are known as macronutrients.

e.g. Carbon, hydrogen, oxygen, ~~the~~ (CHO), (NPK) → Nitrogen, Phosphorus, Potassium.

⇒ While as the nutrients required in lesser amount are known as micro-nutrients.

e.g. Copper, Zinc, Nickel



⇒ Manure: It is a natural organic substance, produced by decomposition.

- Substances like plants and animals wastes.

⇒ Types of Manure:

1) Compost: It is prepared by decomposing agricultural waste, household wastes (Vegetable peel) and live stock wastes.

2) Vermi-Compost: Compost prepared by using earth worms.

⇒ Green Manure: The Fast-growing plants are grown and then ploughed and mulched with soil. e.g. Sun-hemp.

⇒ Benefits: It provides

- Nutrients
- Increase water holding capacity.
- Improves texture of soil and aeration
- Reduces reliance on synthetic chemicals which causes soil pollution.